Registration Law, the election laws extend to the Amyotha Hluttaw, Pyithu Hluttaw, and State and Region Hluttaw laws. All these laws have been in force since 2010, and some have been amended since (see Lidauer and Saphy 2014).

9 Elections were also cancelled in forty-one village tracts in Kyaukkyi and Shwegyin townships in eastern Bago Region. Note that the UEC annnouncements of cancellations in 2010 did not include eastern Bago, but it is almost certain that there were no elections as this area had been under KNU control for decades. The 2010 notifications only cover areas where elections were officially cancelled, while the number of areas where elections did not take place in practice might have been significantly higher.

10 See the UEC FAQ on Voter List Update, February 2015. This and other electoral reference documents can be found on <http://www.merin-online.org/english-resources/>. Accessed 6 February 2015.

11 In several situations in Kachin State and in northern Shan State, the cancellations concern areas that have been vacated during years of conflict, meaning that villages were either destroyed or left at some point during the last two to three decades. The names of these places are nevertheless still part of official records and get included in constituency demarcation, and therefore elections were declared for these locations in the first place. In these cases, the cancellations can be interpreted as rectifying an administrative error while still relating to the security narrative commonly used to explain the phenomenon.

12 The second announcement included the partial cancellations of elections in Hopang township in the Wa SAD which appeared to have been forgotten in the first notification.

13 Interview with the Loilen subcommission on 7 November 2015.

14 Interview with an RCSS Liaison Officer on 12 January 2016.

15 Radio Free Asia on 27 October 2015, <http://www.rfa.org/english/news/myanmar/election-10272015172919.html> Accessed 5 February 2016.

16 The census data is inherently different from the voter list as it relates to anonymous household-based information from people who were present at particular locations during the enumeration. The voter list consists of data of individuals based on their registration status. Census enumeration was conducted in a proactive manner, while the voter list was at first established passively, on the basis of household lists and GAD logbooks, before voters were encouraged to actively check their inclusion on the list. This is not to say that census data were of no use for electoral preparations, but to underline that the census did not generate the voter list. Census data can be used to interpret patterns in the voter list with degrees of approximation, and can be used to interpret particular elements of the process, for example, literacy in relation to voter education or the availability of ID documents among voters, while acknowledging that gaps remain.